Figure 12.6 explain the domain name and label clearly. challenger.atc.fhda.edu. is the domain name which is obtained by reading the labels from bottom to top, separating each label by dot (.) Refer Figure 12.7

Domain name

It is the sequence of labels. In domain name the sequence of labels are separated by dot (.). The domain name is always read from the lower level to higher level i.e., from the leaf node to root node. Since the root node always represent NULL string, all the domain name end with dot.

Basic rules of Domain names

- Domain can consists of Alphabets a through z, and the digits 0 through 9.
- Hyphens are allowed, but hyphens can not be used as first character of a domain name.
- Spaces are not allowed
- Special symbols (such as !, $, &, _ and so on) are not permitted.
- Domain names have the minimum length of 2, and the maximum length of 63 characters. The entire name may be at most 253 characters long.
- Domain names are not case-sensitive. (It may be upper, lower or mixing of both case letters)

Generic Top-Level Domain names:

Top level domain is the last part of a domain name. Generic top level domains are used for generic purpose and maintained by IANA. Refer Table 12.1

Table 12.1 Generic Domain Names

Domain Name	Meaning
com	Commercial Organisation
edu	Educational Institutions
gov	Government (US)
mil	Military groups
org	Non profit Organization
net	Networking organization
info	Information service providers

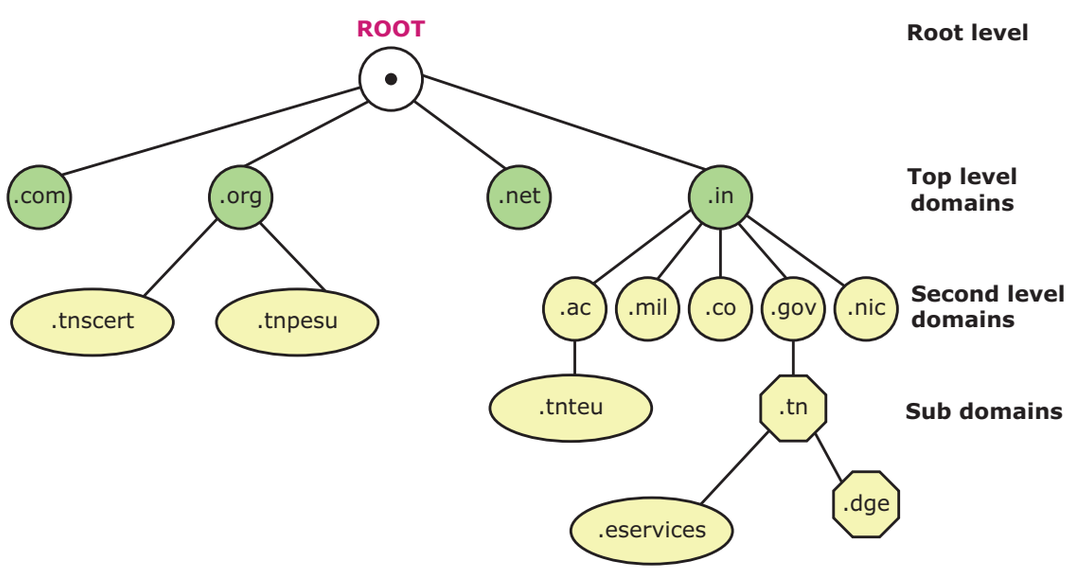


Figure 12.7 Domain representation of www.tnscert.org

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